

reusable-footnotes

Page-local reusable bibliographic footnotes for Quarto

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Why this pattern matters

reusable-footnotes is designed for a citation pattern that is especially common in **Law**. Legal scholarship, briefs, opinions, memoranda, and books frequently place bibliographic references in page footnotes rather than relying only on a final reference list. The same practice is also familiar in **History, Philosophy, Theology, Classics, literary studies, and other Humanities disciplines**.

The important distinction is between the **bibliographic source** and its **footnote occurrences**. BibTeX should define the source once; Quarto should decide how that source is rendered wherever it is used.

For printable outputs, this has an important practical consequence. In **PDF** and **DOCX**, the reader can encounter the full source at the bottom of the same page as the proposition it supports. A reference cited again on another page can therefore appear again on that later page, while repeated uses on the *same* page can share one footnote.

The intended page-local behavior is:

page 1	$A^1 \dots A^1 \dots B^2$	
	¹ Full reference A	
	² Full reference B	
page 2	$A^3 \dots A^3 \dots B^4$	# continuous numbering
	³ Full reference A	
	⁴ Full reference B	

or, when numbering restarts on every page:

page 1	$A^1 \dots A^1 \dots B^2$
page 2	$A^1 \dots A^1 \dots B^2$

In both cases, the source is repeated **between pages**, but not unnecessarily duplicated **within the same page**.

BibTeX and full bibliography entries

A normal Pandoc/Quarto citation remains completely unchanged:

```
A normal citation stays normal: [@silva2026].
```

For example: a normal citation stays normal (Silva 2026).

The development version of Fred Guth’s bibentry extension adds a second representation:

```
[@silva2026]{.bibentry}
```

That form prints the **full bibliography entry using the bibliography layout of the active CSL style**. It does not redefine what @silva2026 means.

Here is the full entry inline:

Silva, José Afonso da. 2026. *Curso de Direito Constitucional Positivo*. 47th ed. São Paulo: JusPodivm.

With:

```
bibliography: references.bib  
csl: your-style.csl
```

ordinary citations use the CSL citation layout, while .bibentry extracts the corresponding bibliography-layout entry.

Legal-style footnotes

The useful composition remains native Pandoc syntax:

```
A legal proposition.^[See [@silva2026]{.bibentry}]
```

Rendered here:

A constitutional proposition may be supported in a page footnote.¹

The Constitution itself can be rendered in full the same way.²

The mechanism is not limited to Law. A historical argument can use the same pattern.³

¹See Silva, José Afonso da. 2026. *Curso de Direito Constitucional Positivo*. 47th ed. São Paulo: JusPodivm.

²See Brasil. 1988. “Constituição Da República Federativa Do Brasil de 1988.” Brasília, DF: Presidência da República. https://www.planalto.gov.br/ccivil_03/constituicao/constituicao.htm.

³See Bloch, Marc. 1953. *The Historian’s Craft*. Manchester: Manchester University Press.

Multi-page print demonstration

The following example is intentionally spread over several physical pages using Quarto's native `pagebreak` shortcode. This makes the page-local behavior visible in **PDF** and **DOCX** rather than keeping all examples on one page.

Demonstration page 1

A printable legal document often develops an argument over several paragraphs while keeping authorities immediately available to the reader. The first occurrence below creates the full footnote for José Afonso da Silva.¹

A later sentence on the same page can rely on exactly the same bibliographic footnote without printing the long entry a second time.¹

The Constitution is a distinct source and therefore receives its own footnote.²

This page-local model is useful when the body text is intended to be read on paper or as a paginated digital document: the source remains close to the proposition, but repeated use of the same source does not make the bottom of the page unnecessarily repetitive.

A final sentence on this first page cites the Constitution again. Because the footnote content is identical and the occurrence is on the same page, it reuses the existing note.²

¹See Silva, José Afonso da. 2026. *Curso de Direito Constitucional Positivo*. 47th ed. São Paulo: JusPodivm.

²See Brasil. 1988. "Constituição Da República Federativa Do Brasil de 1988." Brasília, DF: Presidência da República. https://www.planalto.gov.br/ccivil_03/constituicao/constituicao.htm.

Demonstration page 2

This second page deliberately cites the same authorities again. The Silva reference must now be printed again at the bottom of this page, because a reader should not need to return to the previous page to identify the source.¹

A second occurrence on this same page should reuse the new page-local Silva footnote.¹

The Constitution likewise receives a new page-local occurrence here.²

The point is not to treat the bibliographic source as a new source. BibTeX still contains only one `silva2026` entry and one `brasil1988` entry. What changes is the **placement of the footnote instance** in the printable document.

This page ends by citing the Constitution once more, demonstrating reuse within the second page.²

¹See Silva, José Afonso da. 2026. *Curso de Direito Constitucional Positivo*. 47th ed. São Paulo: JusPodivm.

²See Brasil. 1988. “Constituição Da República Federativa Do Brasil de 1988.” Brasília, DF: Presidência da República. https://www.planalto.gov.br/ccivil_03/constituicao/constituicao.htm.

Demonstration page 3

A third page repeats the same pattern. José Afonso da Silva appears again as a footnote on this page.¹

The same source can be invoked again without duplicating the footnote text on this page.¹

A historical source can participate in exactly the same mechanism.²

A second reference to the historical source on the same page reuses its page-local note.²

The result is a document in which each printed page carries the references needed to understand that page, while identical notes are not redundantly printed twice on the same page.

Configuration

The repository example uses page-local reuse and restarts footnote numbering on every page:

```
bibliography: references.bib

filters:
  - bibentry
  - reusable-footnotes

reusable-footnotes:
  enabled: true
  backlinks: true
  scope: page
  numbering: page
  docx-scope: pagebreak

format:
  html:
    toc: true
  pdf:
```

¹See Silva, José Afonso da. 2026. *Curso de Direito Constitucional Positivo*. 47th ed. São Paulo: JusPodivm.

²See Bloch, Marc. 1953. *The Historian's Craft*. Manchester: Manchester University Press.

```
toc: true
pdf-engine: lualatex
docx:
  toc: false
  reference-doc: _extensions/reusable-footnotes/reference-page.docx
```

The main options are:

- `scope: page`: identical notes are reused only within the current page scope and may appear again later.
- `numbering: page`: numbering restarts at 1 on every printed page.
- `numbering: continuous`: numbering continues across pages while reuse remains page-local.
- `docx-scope: pagebreak`: explicit boundaries define deterministic DOCX page scopes before Word performs final layout.
- `backlinks: true`: HTML adds discreet return links for repeated calls to the same local footnote.

For continuous numbering, change only:

```
reusable-footnotes:
  scope: page
  numbering: continuous
  docx-scope: pagebreak
```

For DOCX page-local numbering, the supplied `reference-page.docx` configures Word's native footnote counter to restart on each page. For continuous DOCX numbering, omit that reference document or use a custom continuous-numbering reference DOCX.

HTML websites and books

A standalone HTML document is one scrolling document, so there is no physical-page concept comparable to PDF or DOCX. The whole file is therefore one logical reusable-footnote scope.

A Quarto **website** or **HTML book** is different: each `.qmd` page or chapter is rendered as its own HTML page. The reusable-footnote scope starts fresh for every page, but numbering can either restart or continue globally.

Page-local numbering

Each rendered HTML page starts again at 1; repeated calls within the page reuse the local canonical footnote.

- [Website example — page-local numbering](#)
- [Book example — page-local numbering](#)

```
quarto preview examples/website
quarto preview examples/book
```

Global numbering

The footnote **scope remains page-local**, but the displayed numbers continue across pages. In the examples below, the first page contributes 1, 2, the second 3, 4, and the third 5, 6.

- [Website example — global numbering](#)
- [Book example — global numbering](#)

```
quarto preview examples/website-global
quarto preview examples/book-global
```

Because Quarto renders each HTML page independently, continuous project-wide numbering needs an explicit page order:

```
reusable-footnotes:
  scope: page
  numbering: continuous
  html-order:
    - index.qmd
    - doctrine.qmd
    - constitution.qmd
```

html-order is used only to calculate the numbering offset contributed by earlier pages. It does **not** merge their footnote scopes. A source cited on two pages can therefore appear in both pages' footnote areas while receiving different numbers in a continuous sequence.

This gives four distinct, demonstrable HTML modes in the repository: website/local, website/global, book/local, and book/global.

Why BibTeX remains the source of truth

The author should not copy and paste formatted references into `^[...]`. The `.bib` entry provides the stable bibliographic identity:

```
@book{silva2026,  
  author    = {Silva, José Afonso da},  
  title     = {Curso de direito constitucional positivo},  
  edition   = {47},  
  address   = {São Paulo},  
  publisher = {JusPodivm},  
  year      = {2026},  
  note      = {Coedição Malheiros}  
}
```

The same entry can then be represented in three different ways without duplicating data:

Normal citation: `[@silva2026]`

Full entry: `[@silva2026]{.bibentry}`

Full entry in a footnote: `^[See [@silva2026]{.bibentry}]`

bibentry integration

This repository currently vendors an **extended development version** of Fred Guth's `bibentry` extension under `_extensions/bibentry/` for integration testing. The original project is MIT licensed and remains credited to Frederico Guth.

The proposed upstream changes add recursive AST support, including `.bibentry` inside native footnotes; true inline replacement; a single citeproc pass preserving numeric CSL ordering; and portable AST output for HTML, PDF/LaTeX, DOCX, and Typst.

`bibentry` and `reusable-footnotes` have separate responsibilities:

- **bibentry** resolves a citation key and renders its full CSL bibliography form;
- **reusable-footnotes** decides when an identical footnote occurrence should be reused locally or printed again on a later page.

Output formats

Format	Page-local behavior
HTML document HTML website/book	the whole HTML file is one logical page each .qmd page owns its footnotes; numbering may restart or continue globally
PDF	true physical-page reuse; identical notes print once per page and may reappear on later pages
DOCX	exact reuse within explicit pagebreak-delimited pages; Word can restart numbering on every physical page through the supplied reference document

No Python runtime or post-render Python step is required.

References

- Bloch, Marc. 1953. *The Historian's Craft*. Manchester: Manchester University Press.
- Brasil. 1988. "Constituição Da República Federativa Do Brasil de 1988." Brasília, DF: Presidência da República. https://www.planalto.gov.br/ccivil_03/constituicao/constituicao.htm.
- Silva, José Afonso da. 2026. *Curso de Direito Constitucional Positivo*. 47th ed. São Paulo: JusPodivm.